

their actions, you may be able to save the hassle of moving your accounts and starting from scratch with a new planner.

Then again, don't stick with a planner because it is the easy thing to do. If your financial planner is the culprit of any combination of the abovementioned blunders, it is a problem that needs to be addressed and fixed—either by finding another planner or by being honest with your existing planner.

Statement shock sucks, through and through. But don't take your eye off the ball because of the initial shock of seeing your investments lose value. If the markets are down overall, don't blame your financial planner; they don't have a crystal ball. And if they pass the acid test above, then keep communicating with them; together you will weather this market downturn, as with every other downturn. The media will sensationalize every market correction and somehow identify that this is the worst, the most dramatic, or the hardest whatever since whenever. But time and

time again, slow and steady is what wins the race. — **Nora Dunn**

6 Horrible Financial Products You Should Avoid

Dealing with financial products can be very confusing and stressful, but there are some products that you should absolutely stay away from for the sake of your financial health. Here are six of them.

1. The 401(k) debit card

This product is designed to let people under age 59.5 raid their retirement funds at an ATM. This is a horrible idea because it makes it easy for people to destroy their nest eggs. Early withdrawals carry a 10% penalty plus tax expenses if not paid back in 5 years or less, so \$10 withdrawn from a 401(k) becomes only \$6–\$7 (depending on your tax rate).

In the past it took at least a few forms to do an early withdrawal from a 401(k), so it was not worth the

